

financial wellbeing. Just be aware, invest what you can, and make sure that you're taking advantage of any contributions from your employer, and you should be able to quieten that nagging voice in the back of your head telling you that you'll never be able to afford to retire.

Saving for your children

This could, of course, mean about a hundred different things. If you choose to have children, they are expensive in various and multifaceted ways, from restricting your income and requiring expensive childcare, to feeding and clothing them, and trying to ensure that they are set up for a stable financial future of their own. This is without even considering the hidden financial pressures that come from comparing yourself and what you're able to provide for your children with others around you – especially, of course, on social media. It's a lot of pressure.

If you're reading this before starting a family, but are planning to at some point in the future, one of the best ways that you can protect your financial wellbeing through parenthood is by setting up a saving pot for anything you might need to support you during maternity leave and the early, painfully expensive, years of childcare. I say this not because I think that your parenting ability or right to have children should ever depend on how financially stable or literate you are, but because I know the difference that this would have made to my own